P&C People Skills · Course 1 · Week 3

Listen First, Then Ask

SLO

- 1.4 Demonstrate active listening: full attention, no interrupting, summarising and reflecting back
- 1.5 Use open, probing and clarifying questions, and avoid leading or blaming ones

Models taught

- RASA (Julian Treasure, TED 2011) for listening: Receive, Appreciate, Summarise, Ask
- OARS (Motivational Interviewing) for responding: Open questions, Affirmations, Reflections, Summaries
- The Question Funnel: Open → Probe → Close

Situations walked through step by step

- Quick chat: "Can we have a quick chat?" about a travel form; the real issue (three months of late claims) surfaces after three questions
- Leading vs open: the same exit interview run twice, once with leading questions and once with OARS

22 spoken lines · 298 words · about 2.2 min + Taleemabad intro/outro · LearnFree-style visuals · voice spoken to "you"

#	Spoken line	On screen
01	The fastest way to the real problem is to listen before you ask. read: calmly, with quiet confidence	Title card: **Listen First**, *then ask*
02	When someone asks for a quick chat, the first thing they say is rarely everything. read: knowingly, with a small smile	Iceberg: tip "Can we have a quick chat?"; below the waterline: The real issue
03	Our instinct is to fix things fast, and that is exactly what stops them talking. read: honestly, admitting a common habit	Split: **Fix fast ≠ Listen first**
04	For listening, Julian Treasure's RASA gives you four steps: receive, appreciate, summarise, ask. read: clearly, introducing a simple tool	Model **RASA**: R Receive · A Appreciate · S Summarise · A Ask *(Julian Treasure, 2011)*
05	Receive: put your phone face down, turn towards them, and simply take it in. read: gently and slowly	Model **RASA**: **R Receive** · A Appreciate · S Summarise · A Ask · on screen: Phone down. Face them.
06	Appreciate: small sounds like "hmm" and "go on" show you are with them. read: warmly, almost conversational	Model **RASA**: R Receive · **A Appreciate** · S Summarise · A Ask · on screen: "Hmm... go on."
07	Summarise: start with "so", and say back what you heard. read: with gentle emphasis on the word so	Model **RASA**: R Receive · A Appreciate · **S Summarise** · A Ask · on screen: "So what I'm hearing is..."
08	Ask comes last, and the question funnel tells you the order. read: clearly, setting up the next idea	Model **RASA**: R Receive · A Appreciate · S Summarise · **A Ask** · on screen: Questions come last.
09	Start open, then probe what came up, then close to confirm. read: steadily, one step at a time	Question funnel: Open → Probe → Close
10	Say a field coordinator stops you at the chai station about a confusing travel form. read: lightly, setting an everyday scene	A person speaks: "This new travel form is so confusing."
11	The fixer explains section B in thirty seconds, and the conversation ends there. read: with a wry note, showing the trap	Split screen: **The fixer** "Easy, just fill section B!" | **The listener** (focus: left)
12	Instead you receive and appreciate, and they add that their claims are three months late.	A person speaks: "It's not just the form. My claims are three months late."

#	Spoken line	On screen
	read: softly, letting the truth come out	
13	You summarise: "So it is not only the form, it is the late payments." read: warmly, with understanding	A person speaks: "So it's not only the form. It's the late payments?"
14	Then you funnel: what happened, which months, and shall I chase Finance by Thursday? read: practically, with momentum	Question funnel: Open "What's been happening with your claims?" → Probe "Which months are pending?" → Close "Shall I check with Finance by Thursday?"

⏸ **CHECKPOINT**: the video pauses here; the LMS asks; the learner must answer to continue. *(Not in the video.)*

Q: A content designer is leaving after two years. In the exit interview, which question will teach you the most?

A. You're leaving for a better salary, right?
B. What made you start looking? ✓
C. Why didn't you raise this with us earlier?
D. The team was supportive though, wasn't it?

If right: Exactly. It is open, so they choose what matters, and it carries no assumption, so you hear the real reason instead of the one you expected.

If wrong: "What made you start looking?" is open, so the person decides what matters and you hear the real reason. "You're leaving for a better salary, right?" and "The team was supportive, wasn't it?" are leading questions: they hand over the answer you expect, so you mostly get a polite yes and learn nothing. "Why didn't you raise this earlier?" sounds like blame, so people get defensive and say less. If you need the why, ask "what led you to..." instead.

16	For your replies, OARS from Motivational Interviewing gives four moves: open questions, affirmations, reflections and summaries. read: clearly, introducing the second tool	Model **OARS**: O Open questions · A Affirm · R Reflect · S Summarise *(Motivational Interviewing)*
17	Run an exit interview with leading questions, and you only get the yes you expected. read: with gentle irony	Split screen: **Leading** "You're leaving for a better salary, right?" | **OARS** (focus: left)
18	Run it again with OARS, starting with an open question: what made you start looking? read: warmly, starting again	Model **OARS**: **O Open questions** · A Affirm · R Reflect · S Summarise · on screen: "What made you start looking?"
19	Now you get the truth: they stopped growing after their lead left. read: sincerely, as the honest answer arrives	A person speaks: "Honestly, I stopped growing after my lead left."
20	Affirm their honesty, then reflect it back: so growth mattered more than pay. read: warmly and thoughtfully	Model **OARS**: O Open questions · **A Affirm** · **R Reflect** · S Summarise · on screen: "Thank you for being honest. So growth mattered more than pay."
21	Summarise what you heard, then ask what would have made them stay. read: steadily, bringing it together	Model **OARS**: O Open questions · A Affirm · R Reflect · **S Summarise** · on screen: "So: growth, a new lead, no plan. What would have made you stay?"
22	And swap "why did you" for "what led you to", so it never sounds like blame. read: as a helpful tip	Split screen: **Sounds like blame** "Why did you do that?" | **Sounds curious** "What led you to that?" (focus: right)

#	Spoken line	On screen
23	So listen with RASA, ask from open to closed, and reply with OARS. read: warmly and with energy, a confident close	Recap cards: Listen with RASA · Open → Probe → Close · Reply with OARS